

Day 14 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Geography of India: Transport & Communication; Social Geography

READING MATERIAL

Sixth sub-topic of Geography Unit II. Real evidence shows census/literacy statistics dominate Social Geography questions, while Transport questions favor named firsts/establishment-years and true/false statement-checking.

Q: Real exam: What was Tamil Nadu's population density per the 2011 census?

A: 555 persons per sq km.

Q: Real exam: Rank these Tamil Nadu districts by literacy rate (highest to lowest) per the 2011 census — Nilgiris, Chennai, Thoothukudi, Kanyakumari.

A: Kanyakumari (highest) → Chennai → Thoothukudi → Nilgiris (lowest).

Q: What is India's overall population density (2011 census), and which state/UT has the highest?

A: India's overall density (2011) was about 382 per sq km. Among Union Territories, NCT of Delhi is the most densely populated (~11,297 per sq km); among states, Bihar ranks highest (~1,102 per sq km).

Q: Which delta is known as the 'Granary of South India'?

A: The Cauvery delta.

Q: What is the second staple food of the people of Tamil Nadu (after rice)?

A: Millets.

Q: Name a major hydro-electric power project in Tamil Nadu, and how many major/minor ports does TN have?

A: Mettur Dam is a major hydro-electric project. Tamil Nadu has 3 major ports and 15 minor ports.

Q: In which year was India's first census carried out?

A: 1872.

Q: Which Indian state ranks first in literacy rate (93.91% per the cited figure)?

A: Kerala.

Q: What forms the most important system of road transportation in India, and when was the National Highways Authority of India established?

A: National highways are the most important road transport system. NHAI was established in 1988.

Q: True or False: 'The state of Meghalaya has no railway network.'

A: FALSE — Meghalaya does have limited rail connectivity (e.g., the line to Mendipathar), even though it's one of the least rail-connected states in India.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Tamil Nadu's population density per the 2011 census was approximately:

A. 450 per sq km

B. 555 per sq km ✓

C. 650 per sq km

D. 750 per sq km

Explanation: 555 per sq km. [medium, question-bank-2024]

2. Per the 2011 census, which Tamil Nadu district had the HIGHEST literacy rate among Nilgiris, Chennai, Thoothukudi, and Kanyakumari?

A. The Nilgiris

B. Chennai

C. Thoothukudi

D. Kanyakumari ✓

Explanation: Kanyakumari ranked highest. [hard, question-bank-2026]

3. Which delta is known as the 'Granary of South India'?

- A. Godavari delta
- B. Krishna delta
- C. Cauvery delta ✓**
- D. Mahanadi delta

Explanation: Cauvery delta. [easy, web-research]

4. How many major and minor ports does Tamil Nadu have respectively?

- A. 3 and 15 ✓**
- B. 4 and 15
- C. 3 and 16
- D. 4 and 16

Explanation: 3 major and 15 minor ports. [medium, web-research]

5. India's first census was carried out in which year?

- A. 1872 ✓**
- B. 1875
- C. 1878
- D. 1952

Explanation: 1872. [medium, web-research]

6. Which Indian state has the highest literacy rate?

- A. Assam
- B. Gujarat
- C. Kerala ✓**
- D. Jammu & Kashmir

Explanation: Kerala. [easy, web-research]

7. The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) was established in:

- A. 1988 ✓**
- B. 1990
- C. 1991
- D. 1994

Explanation: 1988. [medium, web-research]

8. True or False: Meghalaya has absolutely no railway network at all.

- A. True
- B. False — it has limited rail connectivity ✓**
- C. True, but only historically
- D. False — it has an extensive network

Explanation: False — Meghalaya has limited but real rail connectivity (e.g., the Mendipathar line). [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Visual Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Visual Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, testing image-based logic rather than text/number puzzles — mirror images, water images, and embedded figures are the standard formats. Note: TNPSC's own answer key has at least one acknowledged disputed mirror-image question, a useful reminder that on visual questions specifically, double-check your own reasoning rather than assuming the 'obvious' answer is automatically right.

Q: What is the rule for a MIRROR image, and what stays the same vs. flips?

A: A mirror image flips LEFT and RIGHT (the right side of the object appears on the left, and vice versa), while TOP and BOTTOM stay the same. Imagine holding the figure up to a vertical mirror.

Q: What is the rule for a WATER image, and how is it different from a mirror image?

A: A water image flips TOP and BOTTOM (it appears upside-down, as if reflected in still water below the object), while LEFT and RIGHT stay the same. This is the opposite axis of flipping compared to a mirror image.

Q: What is the best strategy for solving mirror/water image questions quickly?

A: Focus on the most unique or asymmetric part of the figure first (not the symmetric parts, which look the same either way) — mentally flip just that distinctive part along the correct axis (vertical line for mirror, horizontal line for water), and use it to eliminate options before checking the rest.

Q: What is an 'embedded figure' question, and what does it test?

A: A question where a simple shape is hidden within a more complex, cluttered figure, and you must identify which of the answer-choice shapes appears embedded within it. Tests visual scanning and pattern-matching rather than flipping/rotation.

Q: Real exam (flagged as disputed by TNPSC itself): A figure is shown, and you must choose its correct mirror image from 4 options.

What's the most reliable way to verify your choice, given that even the official answer key has had disputed cases here?

A: Don't just eyeball it — explicitly trace which side each distinctive feature should land on after a left-right flip, point by point, rather than relying on a quick visual impression. Given that TNPSC's own committee has had to review at least one mirror-image answer, treat your worked-through reasoning as more trustworthy than a snap visual judgment, and double-check rather than rushing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In a MIRROR image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom
- B. Left and right ✓**
- C. Diagonal corners only
- D. Nothing swaps

Explanation: Left and right swap; top and bottom stay the same. [easy, web-research]

2. In a WATER image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom ✓**
- B. Left and right
- C. Both pairs swap
- D. Neither swaps

Explanation: Top and bottom swap; left and right stay the same. [easy, web-research]

3. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its mirror image (left-right flip)?

- A. b
- B. d ✓**
- C. p
- D. q

Explanation: 'b' has its stem on the left with the bowl attached at bottom-right. Flipping left-right moves the stem to the right with the bowl at bottom-left — that's the letter 'd'. [medium, authored]

4. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its water image (top-bottom flip)?

- A. b
- B. d

C. p ✓

D. q

Explanation: Flipping 'b' top-to-bottom keeps the stem on the left but moves the bowl from bottom-right to top-right — that's the letter 'p'. (Mirror and water images of the same letter generally differ — here mirror gives 'd', water gives 'p'.) [hard, authored]

5. An 'embedded figure' question primarily tests:

A. Arithmetic ability

B. Visual scanning and pattern-matching within a cluttered figure ✓

C. Vocabulary

D. Memory of a list

Explanation: Visual scanning/pattern-matching to find a hidden shape within a complex figure. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Power of a Smile" — Tupac Shakur

READING MATERIAL

A short poem contrasting destructive emotions (anger, cold/wind) against the healing power of a simple smile. Real coaching-site evidence tests theme and figure-of-speech identification per line.

Q: Who wrote "The Power of a Smile", and what is its central theme?

A: Tupac Shakur. Central theme: the healing power of a smile — contrasted against destructive forces like anger and cold wind.

Q: Which emotion does the poem describe as something that 'tears you apart'?

A: Anger.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The power of wind can chill."

A: Personification — wind is given the active, almost intentional power 'to chill', as if performing a deliberate action.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The power of a smile... can heal a frozen heart."

A: Metaphor — a 'frozen heart' (emotional coldness/numbness) is described directly, and a smile 'heals' it, without using 'like/as'.

Q: What does "can heal a frozen heart" suggest?

A: That a smile can cure sadness/emotional coldness — restoring warmth and feeling, metaphorically 'unfreezing' a hardened or hurt heart.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Power of a Smile" was written by:

A. Langston Hughes

B. Tupac Shakur ✓

C. Maya Angelou

D. W.H. Auden

Explanation: Tupac Shakur. [easy, web-research]

2. The central theme of the poem is:

A. Anger and power

B. Natural forces

C. The healing power of a smile ✓

D. War and peace

Explanation: The healing power of a smile. [easy, web-research]

3. Which emotion is described in the poem as something that 'tears you apart'?

A. Joy

B. Sadness

C. Anger ✓

D. Hope

Explanation: Anger. [medium, web-research]

4. "The power of wind can chill" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Metaphor

C. Personification ✓

D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Personification — wind given the active power 'to chill'. [medium, web-research]

5. "The power of a smile... can heal a frozen heart" uses which figure of speech?

A. Metaphor ✓

B. Irony

C. Alliteration

D. Onomatopoeia

Explanation: Metaphor — a 'frozen heart' described directly, without 'like/as'. [medium, web-research]

6. "Can heal a frozen heart" suggests that a smile can:

A. Cause physical damage

B. Cure sadness/emotional coldness ✓

C. Bring summer weather

D. Make the heart literally turn to ice

Explanation: Cure sadness/emotional coldness. [easy, web-research]